

Important Information. Please read carefully.

Xepanicol[®]

Eye Drops



Composition

Chloramphenicol 0.5%w/v in a sterile, buffered and isotonic aqueous ophthalmic solution. Benzalkonium Chloride 0.01%w/v as preservative.

Pharmacodynamics

Chloramphenicol is thought to enter sensitive cells by an active transport process. Within the cell it binds to the 50S subunit of the bacterial ribosome at a site adjacent to the site of action of the macrolides and clindamycin, and inhibits bacterial protein synthesis by preventing attachment of aminoacyl transfer RNA to its acceptor site on the ribosome, thus preventing peptide bond formation by peptidyl transferase. The block in protein synthesis results in a primarily bacteriostatic action, although it may be bactericidal to some organisms, including *Haemophilus influenzae*, and *Neisseria meningitidis*, at higher concentrations.

Pharmacokinetics

When used orally, chloramphenicol is widely distributed in body tissues and fluids; it enters the CSF, giving concentrations of about 50% of those existing in the blood even in the absence of inflamed meninges; it diffuses across the placenta into the fetal circulation, into breast milk, and into the aqueous and vitreous humours of the eye. It also enters the aqueous humour after topical application. Up to about 60% in the circulation is bound to plasma protein. The half-life of chloramphenicol has been reported to range from 1.5 to 4 hours. Chloramphenicol is excreted mainly in the urine. About 3% is excreted in the bile.

Indications

Treatment of bacterial conjunctivitis and other superficial ocular infections caused by organisms susceptible to chloramphenicol.

Dosage and Administration

For eye application only.

Unless otherwise prescribed by the physician

Instill into affected eye(s) one to two drops four to six times a day for the first two days after which the dose can be reduced. It is advisable to continue treatment for 48 hours after the eye appears normal.

Contraindications

Xepanicol eye drops should not be used in persons with a history of sensitivity to chloramphenicol or any other component of the eye drops.

Precautions

Avoid use over a prolonged period as like other antibacterial preparations this may lead to overgrowth of non-susceptible organisms. There is also greater risk of systemic absorption with prolonged use. It is not advisable for use in pregnant women unless under close medical supervision.

Drug Interactions

Systemically, interactions may occur with phenobarbitone or rifampicin.

Overdosage and Treatment

Accidental ingestion of the eye drops is unlikely to cause any toxicity due to the low content of antibiotic.

Side Effects

Hypersensitivity reactions including rashes, fever and angioedema may occur especially after topical use. If so, treatment should be discontinued. Rare cases of blood dyscrasias have been reported with prolonged or frequent intermittent use of topical chloramphenicol due to absorption into the general circulation.

Shelf-life

The expiry date is indicated on the packaging.

Presentation

A clear, colourless to yellowish, sterile, buffered, preserved aqueous ophthalmic solution.

Storage

Store in refrigerator between 2-8°C. Do not freeze.

Discard eye drops 4 weeks after the first opening.

KEEP OUT OF REACH OF CHILDREN

JAUHI DARI KANAK-KANAK

For further information, please consult your pharmacist or physician.

Revision Date: XX-XX-XXXX

Manufacturer and Product Registration Holder (In Malaysia):

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Internal Code Area

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